

UNITED NATIONS **NATIONS UNIES**
DEPARTMENT OF ECONOMIC AND SOCIAL AFFAIRS

**ITALIAN FELLOWSHIPS PROGRAMME
FOR TECHNICAL COOPERATION
CAPACITY BUILDING AND HUMAN RESOURCES DEVELOPMENT
2025-2026**

Fellowship Award Specification

**United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO)
Regional Office for Eastern Africa**

1. General Information

<u>Title:</u>	UN Fellow
<u>Orientation Workshop dates:</u>	May 2026 (tbc)
<u>Assignment in the field dates:</u>	May 2026 – May 2027 (tbc)
<u>Duty Station:</u>	Nairobi, Kenya
<u>Sector of assignment:</u>	Education

2. Supervision

<u>Name of the Supervisor:</u>	Scheherazade Feddal
<u>Title of the Supervisor:</u>	Education Programme Specialist – OiC Education Sector

3. Background information

UNESCO, the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization, is a specialized agency dedicated to strengthening our shared humanity through the promotion of education, science, culture, and communication.

We set standards, produce tools and develop knowledge to create solutions to some of the greatest challenges of our time, and foster a world of greater equality and peace.

Established in 1965, the UNESCO Regional Office for Eastern Africa in Nairobi supports 13 countries: Comoros, Djibouti, Ethiopia, Eritrea, Kenya, Madagascar, Mauritius, Rwanda, Seychelles, Somalia, South Sudan, United Republic of Tanzania, and Uganda.

The mission of UNESCO Nairobi in the Region is to support Member States in strengthening education and training systems to provide high quality, equitable and inclusive education and training for all and equip children, young people and adults with skills for life and work, values and attitudes to build secure, resilient and sustainable societies.

4. Duties, responsibilities and output expectations:

Under the overall authority of the UNESCO Regional Director for Eastern Africa, the guidance of the Education Specialist and Head of the Education Unit, the incumbent will be responsible for providing programme and administrative support to ensure effective, planning, implementation and monitoring of UNESCO's work in Education, specifically in the area of gender equality, Youth empowerment, advocacy for higher education conventions ratification, or related fields in nine (9) Expected Results areas in the Education Sector. Specifically, s/he will be responsible for providing programme and administrative support including record keeping as follows:

- Support the visibility and communication on education events including the drafting of news articles, social media message as well as the production of photos and videos
- Prepare and participate in workshops, conferences, forums, meetings or other collaborative events and their follow-up which includes the drafting of reports on workshops, seminars and meetings conducted in line with specified reporting requirements
- Maintain and update the filing system to ensure efficient storage and retrieval of documentation relating to the programme and operations
- Take minutes, prepare presentations and documents for in-house and external meetings as required
- Assist in compiling and adapting documents, news, human interest stories, photo galleries and other dynamic content for regular updating the Regional Office's web site
- Provide administrative and logistical support for programme implementation, and
- Perform other duties in support of the work of the Education Unit as delegated by the Education Specialist and Head of Education Unit.

5. Qualifications and Experience

Education

Advanced university degree (Master's degree or equivalent) in the Social Sciences including education and education planning, psychology, gender studies, development studies, public policy and public administration.

Work experience

One year of professional experience in analysis, planning, development, management and implementation of education programmes.

Languages

Excellent knowledge of English; knowledge of another UNESCO official language, especially French, is an asset.

Other skills

- Demonstrated research abilities and interest
- Good oral and written communication skills
- Willingness to learn
- Internet proficiency as well as proficiency in MS Office (Word, Excel, PowerPoint)

- Experience in working or volunteering in the thematic areas of education, development studies, and gender equality is an added advantage
- Ability to work in a multicultural environment

Competencies

Core values: Integrity, Professionalism and Respect for Diversity

Core competencies:

- Communication: ability to communicate clearly and request clarification when needed
- Accountability: drive for results, demonstrate responsibility, rectify mistakes
- Teamwork: ability to function and interact with team members and across the office

6. Learning Elements

The general objective of the fellowship is to gain professional experience in the implementation of education sector initiatives within UNESCO, enhancing the trainee understanding of the organization's structure, functions, and working methods. As part of the Sponsored Traineeship Programme, the specific objective is to provide hands-on experience in international development, with a focus on inclusive education, gender equality, and youth empowerment in the African context. Over the duration of the assignment beginning in May 2026, the trainee will contribute to the design, implementation, and monitoring of relevant initiatives, while supporting policy dialogue, stakeholder engagement, and knowledge-sharing efforts.

7. Content and methodology of the supervision

In the Education Sector, UNESCO's goal is to support Member States to implement the Sustainable Development Goal (SDG4). SDG4 calls on the Member States to ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all.

To ensure a successful traineeship experience, UNESCO would provide support to the trainee with a comprehensive onboarding package that includes an overview of its mission, structure, and key programmes, particularly in education, gender equality, and youth. Access to relevant background documents, strategic plans, and stakeholder maps would help the trainee understand the context and priorities of the Nairobi Office. Practical resources such as training on internal tools, a calendar of upcoming events, and guidance on local customs and office protocols would ease integration. Additionally, a clear supervision and mentorship plan, along with opportunities for learning and development, would enhance the intern's engagement and professional growth throughout the assignment.

8. Living conditions in the country

Nairobi, the capital of Kenya, is a major political, economic, and cultural hub in Eastern Africa, hosting numerous United Nations agencies, international organizations, and diplomatic missions. The city offers a wide range of housing, education, and healthcare options, as well as reliable internet and communication infrastructure. While living costs vary depending on location and lifestyle, adequate accommodation and essential services are readily available. Nairobi has a moderate climate throughout the year and offers rich cultural and recreational opportunities, although usual precautions related to urban safety are advised.

Nairobi hosts the UN HQ for Africa – UNON – as well as other NGOs i.e. IRC, VSO, Save the Children; and private sectors regional HQ such as Google, Microsoft and include expats from both public and private sectors, but also host the largest slum in Africa